MINDFULNESS SESSION 1

Goals of Mindfulness
States of Mind: Wise Mind

Goals of Mindfulness Practice

REDUCE SUFFERING AND INCREASE HAPPINESS

☐ Reduce pain, tension, and stress.

☐ Other: _____

INCREASE CONTROL OF YOUR MIND

☐ Stop letting your mind be in control of you.

☐ Other: _____

EXPERIENCE REALITY AS IT IS

☐ Live life with your eyes wide open

☐ Experience the reality of your . . .

- connection to the universe.
- essential "goodness."
- essential validity.

☐ Other: _____

Mindfulness Definitions

WHAT IS MINDFULNESS?

- **Intentionally living with awareness in the present moment.**
  (Waking up from automatic or rote behaviors to participate and be present to our own lives.)
- **Without judging or rejecting the moment.**
  (Noticing consequences, discerning helpfulness and harmfulness—but letting go of evaluating, avoiding, suppressing, or blocking the present moment.)
- **Without attachment to the moment.**
  (Attending to the experience of each new moment, rather than ignoring the present by clinging to the past or grabbing for the future.)

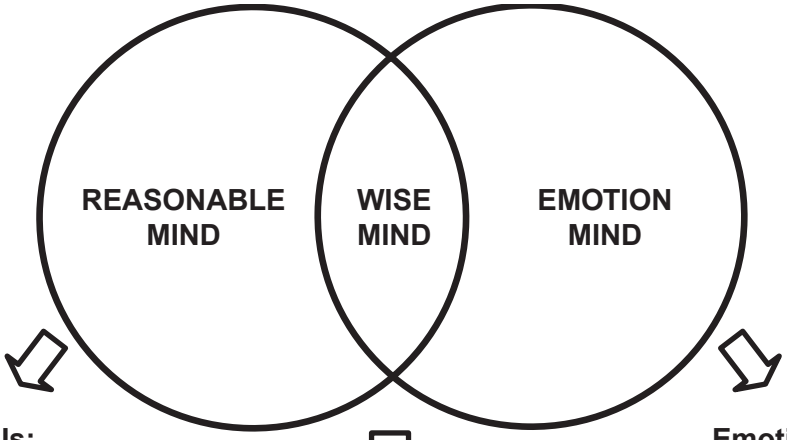
WHAT ARE MINDFULNESS SKILLS?

- Mindfulness skills are the specific behaviors to practice that, when put together, make up mindfulness.

WHAT IS MINDFULNESS PRACTICE?

- **Mindfulness and mindfulness skills** can be practiced at any time, anywhere, while doing anything. Intentionally paying attention to the moment, without judging it or holding on to it, is all that is needed.
- **Meditation** is practicing mindfulness and mindfulness skills while sitting, standing, or lying quietly for a predetermined period of time. When meditating, we *focus* the mind (for example, we *focus* on body sensations, emotions, thoughts, or our breath), or we *open* the mind (paying attention to whatever comes into our awareness). There are many forms of meditation that differ mostly by whether we are opening the mind or focusing the mind—and, if focusing, depending on what is the focus of our attention.
- **Contemplative prayer** (such as Christian centering prayer, the rosary, Jewish Shema, Islamic Sufi practice, or Hindu raja yoga) is a spiritual mindfulness practice.
- **Mindfulness movement** also has many forms. Examples include yoga, martial arts (such as Qigong, tai chi, akido, and karate), and spiritual dancing. Hiking, horseback riding, and walking can also be ways to practice mindfulness.

Wise Mind: States of Mind



Reasonable Mind Is:

Cool

Rational

Task-Focused

When in *reasonable mind,* you are ruled by facts, reason, logic, and pragmatics. Values and feelings are not important.

Wise Mind Is:

The wisdom within each person

Seeing the value of both reason and emotion

Bringing left brain and right brain together

The middle path

Emotion Mind Is:

Hot

Mood-Dependent

Emotion-Focused

When in *emotion mind,* you are ruled by your moods, feelings, and urges to do or say things. Facts, reason, and logic are not important.

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Overview:
Loving Kindness

Mindfulness Practice:

Loving Kindness

Overview: Other perspectives on mindfulness

Skillfull Means:

Taking hold of your everyday life by balancing Doing mind and Being mind

Wise Mind:

Walking the middle path

Practicing Loving Kindness to Increase Love and Compassion

WHAT IS LOVING KINDNESS?

Loving kindness is a mindfulness practice designed to increase love and compassion first for ourselves and then for our loved ones, for friends, for those we are angry with, for difficult people, for enemies, and then for all beings.

Loving kindness can protect us from developing and holding on to judgmentalness, ill will, and hostile feelings toward ourselves and others.

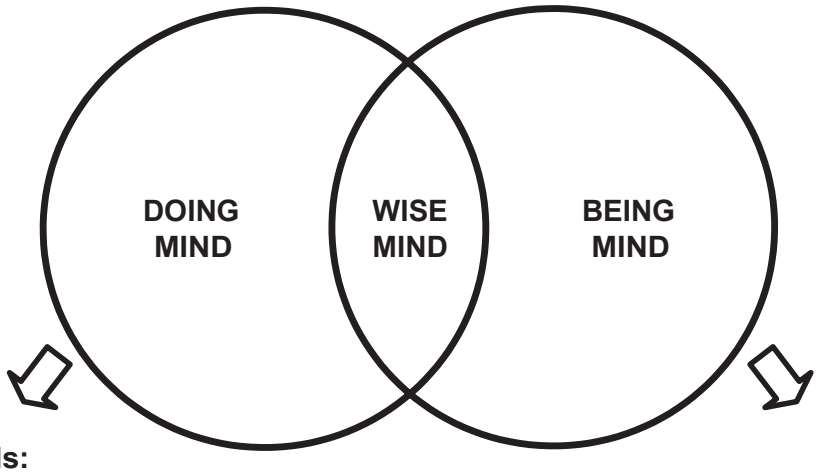
PRACTICING LOVING KINDNESS

Practicing loving kindness is like saying a prayer for yourself or someone else. As when you are asking or praying for something for yourself or others, you actively send loving and kind wishes, and recite in your mind words and phrases that express good will toward yourself and others.

LOVING KINDNESS INSTRUCTIONS

1. Choose a person to send loving kindness toward. Do *not* select a person you do not want to relate to with kindness and compassion. Start with yourself, or, if this is too difficult, with a person you already love.
2. Sitting, standing, or lying down, begin by breathing slowly and deeply. Opening the palms of your hands, gently bring the person to mind.
3. Radiate loving kindness by reciting a set of warm wishes, such as “May I be happy,” “May I be at peace,” “May I be healthy,” “May I be safe,” or another set of positive wishes of your own. Repeat the script slowly, and focus on the meaning of each word as you say it in your mind. (If you have distracting thoughts, just notice them as they come and go and gently bring your mind back to your script.) Continue until you feel yourself immersed in loving kindness.
4. Gradually work yourself up through loved ones, friends, those you are angry with, difficult people, enemies, and finally all beings. For example, use a script such as “May John be happy,” “May John be at peace,” and so on (or “John, may you be happy,” “May you be at peace,” and so on), as you concentrate on radiating loving kindness to John.
5. Practice each day, starting with yourself and then moving to others.

Skillful means:
Balancing Doing mind and Being mind



Doing Mind Is:

- **Discriminating Mind**
- **Ambitious Mind**
- **Goal-Oriented**

When in *doing mind,* you view your thoughts as facts about the world. You are focused on problem solving and achieving goals.

Wise Mind Is:

- A balance of doing and being
- The middle path

When in Wise Mind, you:

Use skillful means.

Let go of having to achieve goals—and throw your entire self into working toward these same goals.

Enhance awareness while engaging in activities.

Being Mind Is:

- **Curious Mind**
- **Nothing-to-Do Mind**
- **Present-Oriented**

When in *being mind,* you view your thoughts as sensations of the mind. You are focused on the uniqueness of each moment, letting go of focusing on goals.

Note. The terms "doing mind," "being mind," and "nothing-to-do mind" were first used by Jon Kabat-Zinn in *Full Catastrophe Living* (1990, 2013).

Walking the Middle Path: Finding the Synthesis between Opposites

Reasonable mind ⟷ **Emotion mind**

Both regulate actions and make decisions based on reason,
and
take into account values, and experience even strong emotions as they come and go.

Doing mind ⟷ **Being mind**

Both do what is needed in the moment (including reviewing the past or planning for the future),
and
Experience fully the uniqueness of each moment in the moment.

Intense desire for change of the moment ⟷ **Radical acceptance of the moment**

Both allow yourself to have an intense desire to have something else than what is now,
and
be willing to radically accept what you have in your life in the present moment.

Self-denial ⟷ **Self-indulgence**

Both practice moderation, ***and*** satisfy the senses.

Other:

_____ ⟷ _____

_____ ⟷ _____

Wise Mind Practice

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Wise Mind Practice Exercise: Check off an exercise each time you do one.

❑❑❑❑ **1.** Attended to my breath coming in and out, letting my attention settle into my center.

❑❑❑❑ **2.** Imagined being a flake of stone on the lake.

❑❑❑❑ **3.** Imagined walking down an inner spiral stairs.

❑❑❑❑ **4.** Dropped into the pauses between inhaling and exhaling.

❑❑❑❑ **5.** Breathed "wise" in, "mind" out.

❑❑❑❑ **6.** Asked Wise Mind a question (breathing in) and listened for the answer (breathing out).

❑❑❑❑ **7.** Asked myself, "Is this Wise Mind?"

❑❑❑❑ **8.** Other (describe): _____

❑❑❑❑ **9**. Other (describe): _____

Describe the situation and how you practiced Wise Mind:

_____

_____

How effective was the practice in helping you become centered in your Wise Mind?

Not effective: I couldn't do the skill for even 1 minute. I got distracted or quit.		*Somewhat effective: I was able to practice Wise Mind and became somewhat centered in my Wise Mind.*		*Very effective: I became centered in Wise Mind, and was free to do what needed to be done.*
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**

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1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

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Ideas for Practicing Balancing Doing mind and Being mind

The mindfulness skills require a lot of practice. The practice ideas below are to help you act skillfully in everyday life, bringing together doing activities of everyday life with being mind.

1. **Wise mind reading.** To increase your desire for mindfulness, find readings or quotations that have the effect of making you actually want to practice mindfulness in your everyday life. Put these quotations at strategic spots in your life (e.g., near the coffee maker), and then while you are waiting for other things, read the inspirational messages.

2. **Wise mind reminders.** Set an alarm at home, at work, or (if possible) on your cell phone or watch to go off randomly or at set times. Use the alarm as a reminder to be mindful of your current activities. (See *www.mindfulnessdc.org/bell/index.html* or a similar Internet site for a free mindfulness clock to download onto your computer.) Set up automatic text messages or Twitter messages to remind yourself. Write out mindfulness quotations that you like, and tape them in strategic places where you will see them as reminders to practice mindfulness.

3. **Wise mind in the routine of daily life.** Choose one routine activity in your daily life (such as brushing your teeth, getting dressed, making coffee or tea, working on a task). Make a deliberate effort to bring moment-to-moment awareness to that activity.

4. **"Just this one moment" Wise mind.** When you begin to feel overwhelmed or frazzled, say, "Just this one moment, just this one task," to remind yourself that your only requirement at the moment is to do one thing in the moment—wash one dish, take one step, move one set of muscles. In this moment, let the next moment go until you get there.

(***continued on next page***)

Note. Exercises 3 and 4 are from Segal, Z. V., Williams, J. M. G., & Teasdale, J. D. (2013). *Mindfulness-based cognitive therapy for depression: A new approach to preventing relapse* (2nd ed.). New York: Guilford Press. Copyright 2013 by The Guilford Press. Adapted by permission. All other exercises are adapted from Kabat-Zinn, J. (1990). *Full catastrophe living: Using the wisdom of your body and mind to face stress, pain, and illness.* New York: Delacorte Press. Copyright 1990 by Jon Kabat-Zinn. Adapted by permission of Random House.

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5. **Wise mind awareness of events.** Notice events in your everyday life (both pleasant and unpleasant), even if they are only very small (such as warm water on your hands when washing, the taste of something you eat, the feel of wind on your face, the fact that your car is running out of gas or that you are tired).

6. **Wise mind awareness of what needs to be done.** When relaxing after a hard day's work or at a break during the day, stay aware of what needs to be done and focus on doing what is needed.

7. **Wise mind willingness.** Practice willingness to do what is needed when you are asked, or when you see that something needs to be done. Do what is needed with a balance of being and doing, focusing the mind, immersing yourself in the task.

8. **Three-minute WISE MIND Slowing down "doing mind" in your everyday life**

   - Bring yourself into the present moment by adopting a "wide-awake" posture, and then, in Wise Mind, ask, "What is my experience right now? What thoughts and images are going through my mind?" Notice them as mental events, as neural firing in your brain. Next ask, "What are my feelings and sensations in my body?" Notice these as they come into your awareness. Then say, "OK, this is how it is right now."

   - Settle into Wise Mind and focus your entire attention on your breath as it goes in and as it goes out, one breath after another. Gather yourself all together, and focus on the movements of your chest and abdomen, the rise and fall of your breath, moment by moment, breath by breath as best you can. Let your breath become an anchor to bring you into the present moment.

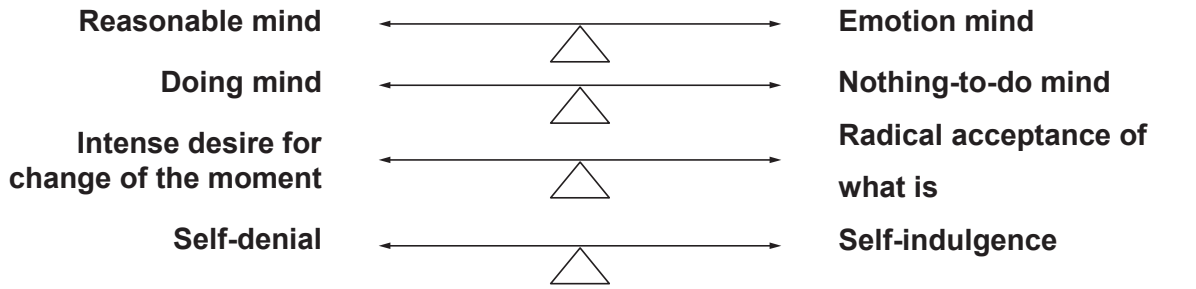
   - Once you have gathered yourself to some extent, allow your awareness to expand. As well as being aware of the breath, include also a sense of the body as a whole, your posture, your facial expression, your hands. Follow the breath as if your whole body is breathing. When you are ready, step back into your activities, acting from Wise Mind of your whole body in the present moment.

9. **Other Wise Mind practice ideas:** _____

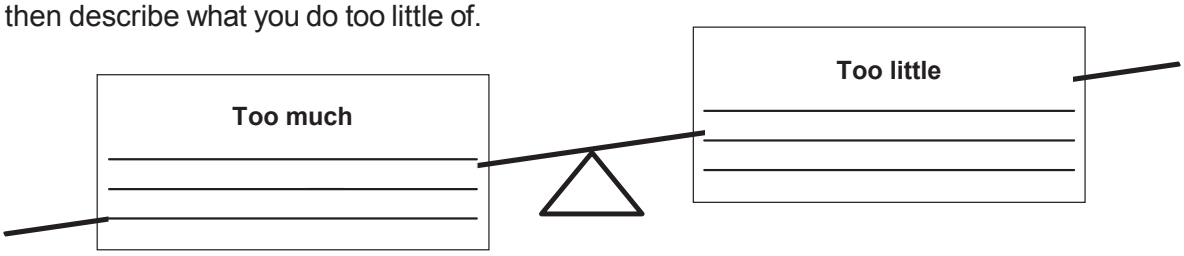
Analyzing Yourself on the Middle Path

Due Date:_____ Name:_____Week Starting: _____

1. **Figure out where you are off the middle path, toward one extreme or the other.** For each of the following Wise Mind dilemmas, put an X on the line that represents where you think you are most of the time. If you are fairly balanced, put the X in the middle. If you are out of balance, put the X near the end that you are too extreme on.

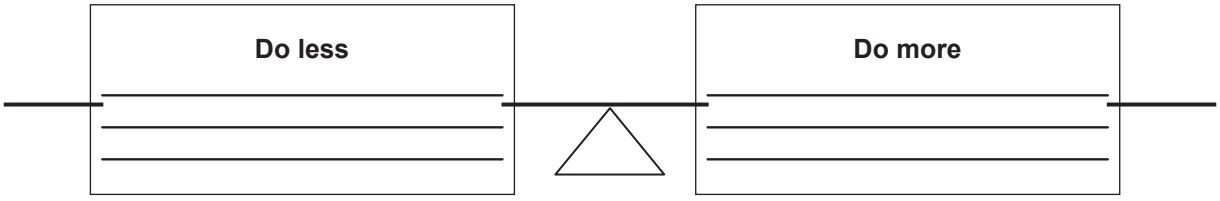


2. **Choose one dilemma.** Describe *very specifically* what you are doing that is too much, and then describe what you do too little of.



3. **Check the facts.** Check for interpretations and opinions. Make sure that your list of activities you do too much of or too little of is in fact accurate. Check your own values in Wise Mind: Be sure to work on your middle path, not someone else's. Also check for **judgments.** Avoid "good," "bad," and judgmental language. Rewrite any items above if needed so that they are **factual and nonjudgmental.**

4. **Decide** on one (or at most two) *very specific* things to do in the next week to get closer to balance.



5. **Describe** what you did since last week: _____

6. **Rate** how effective the practice was in helping you become more balanced on the middle path. Rate it from 1 (did not help at all) to 5 (very effective, really helped): _____

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

Goals of Mindfulness Practice: A Spiritual Perspective

TO EXPERIENCE :

- ❑ Ultimate reality *as it is* which leads to a sense of inner spaciousness and awareness of intimate wholeness with the entire universe, the transcendence of boundaries, and the ground of our being.
- ❑ Other: _____

TO GROW IN WISDOM:

- ❑ Of the heart and of action.
- ❑ Other: _____

TO EXPERIENCE FREEDOM:

- ❑ By letting go of attachments to the demands of your own desires, cravings, and intense emotions, and radically accepting reality as it is.
- ❑ Other: _____

TO INCREASE LOVE AND COMPASSION :

- ❑ Toward yourself.
- ❑ Toward others.
- ❑ Other: _____

❑ **Other:** _____

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Wise Mind from a Spiritual Perspective

Wise Mind as . . . **Contemplative practice** Mindfulness Meditation Contemplative prayer Contemplative action Centering prayer	Thoughts, attitudes, and actions designed to help us express or experience connection to: • The sacred, the divine within, the transcendent. • God, the Great Spirit, the Absolute, Elohim, the nameless one, Brahma, Allah, Parvardigar. • Ultimate reality, the totality, the source, our essential nature, our true self, the core of our being, the ground of being. • No self, emptiness.
Wise mind experience from a spiritual perspective	Experience where a deeper layer of reality rises to consciousness. A reality that has always been there but has been misperceived. An experience of expansion of consciousness; the experience of unity and oneness within the sacred.
Wise mind **from the perspective of mysticism** **(**seven characteristics of mystical experiences)	1. **Direct experience:** Experience without words of *ultimate reality.* 2. **Experience of unity:** Awareness of oneness and of no distance between oneself, reality, and all other beings. 3. **Without words:** Experience of reality that cannot be grasped and can only be described with metaphors and stories. 4. **Certain:** During the experience, certainty of the experience is total, undeniable, clear. 5. **Practical:** Experience that is concretely beneficial to one's life and well-being. 6. **Integrative:** Experience that establishes harmony of love, compassion, mercy, kindness; quieting of extreme emotions. 7. **Sapiential:** Experience that leads to wisdom, enhances capacity for intuitive knowledge.